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Soyeon Park

Education

Michigan State University — East Lansing, MI, USA
Ph.D., Political Science — expected 2027
- Fields: International Relations (major), Methodology (minor: passed with distinction)
- Dissertation: Evolving Human Rights: Overlaps, Expanding Meanings, and the Strategic Behavior of Victims
- Committee: Cristina Bodea (chair), Shahryar Minhas, Ana Bracic, Andy Halterman
- *Graduate Certificate in Computational Modeling* - Department of Computational Mathematics, Science and Engineering

Korea University — Seoul, Korea
M.A., Political Science — 2021

Sogang University — Seoul, Korea
B.A., Global Korean Studies and Political Science — 2019
- Summa cum laude (with highest honor in the School of Integrated Knowledge)

Australian National University — Canberra, Australia
Exchange program, College of Asia and the Pacific — Spring 2017

Research & Teaching Interests

International Law, International Organizations, Human Rights, Non-State Actors, European Law and Courts, Legal Mobilization and Social Movements, International Institutions and Domestic Politics, Mixed-Methods, Causal Inference, Computational Text Analysis

Peer-Reviewed Publication

1. **Soyeon Park**. 2025. "When International Meets Domestic: The Interactive Effect of Domestic and International Election Observers." *International Interactions* 51 (6), 992–1022.
   * Winner of the *2024 PLS Best Graduate Paper Award*, Department of Political Science, Michigan State University
   * Winner of the *2024-2025 Graduate Student Research Award*, College of Social Science, Michigan State University

Working Papers

1. Selecting Justice: Strategic Forum Choice among Overlapping Human Rights Institutions. *Under review*
2. Evolving Human Rights: The Politics of Human Rights Treaty Interpretation. *Preparing for submission*
3. How Do Poorly Ratified International Human Rights Treaties Protect Victims? - Case of the Migrant Workers Convention in a Non-member State.
4. Who Gets Heard? A Network Analysis of NGOs' Impact on Global Human Rights Governance. (with Shanshan Lian)
5. Beyond Original Provisions: Interpretive Change and the Effects of Treaties.
6. Why Governments Say Yes: International Women, Peace, and Security (WPS) Norms and the Adoption of Gender Provisions in Peace Agreements. (with San Lee)
7. Making Rights: How Non-State Actors Transform International Human Rights Law. *Book project in development*

Fellowships, Grants & Awards

External

Law and Science Dissertation Grant
National Science Foundation (SBE #2016661) 2025

Humane Studies Fellowship ($3,000)
Institute for Humane Studies (IHS) 2025

NYU Faculty First Look Scholar
New York University Arts & Science Faculty First Look program 2025

Committee on the Status of LGBT Individuals Travel Grant
American Political Science Association 2025

Pay-It-Forward
International Studies Association 2025

First Generation Scholar Travel and Accessibility Grant
American Political Science Association 2023

Travel Grant ($1,300)
International Studies Association 2022, 2025

Best Group Presentation Award
Graduate School of Asia-Pacific Studies, Waseda University 2019

Internal

Dissertation Completion Fellowship ($9,000)
College of Social Science, Michigan State University 2026

2026 Thomas W. Crosby Fellowship ($2,800)
Department of Political Science, Michigan State University 2026

2025 Graduate Student Research Award ($500)
College of Social Science, Michigan State University 2024-2025

Women's and Gender Studies Dissertation Research Fellowship ($10,000)
Center for Gender in Global Context, Michigan State University 2024-2025

2024 PLS Best Graduate Paper Award ($500)
Department of Political Science, Michigan State University 2023-2024

Graduate Student Research Funding (data collection) ($1,500)
Minority Politics Lab, College of Social Science, Michigan State University 2024

Summer Research Grants (data collection) ($7,200)
Department of Political Science, Michigan State University 2023, 2024

Conference Travel Grant
Department of Political Science, Michigan State University 2022-2025

Research Assistant Scholarship
Korea University 2020

Research Associate Fellowship
Social Science Korea Human Rights Forum 2019-2020

Graduate International Program Scholarship
Korea University 2019

Administrative Assistant Scholarship
Office of International Affairs, Sogang University 2017

Honors Scholarship
Sogang University 2015, 2017

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Dr. Cristina Bodea — Fall 2022-Spring 2025
Contributed to a dataset on gender representation in central bank leadership by coding governors, deputy governors, and board members

Research Assistant, Dr. Hun Joon Kim — Fall 2020
Conducted research on state accountability for past human rights violations in South Korea and human rights concerns arising during the COVID-19 pandemic

Research Associate, Social Science Korea Human Rights Forum — Fall 2019-Spring 2020
Synthesized scholarship on the diffusion of transitional justice and researched how U.S.-China competition intersected with human rights controversies surrounding emerging surveillance technologies

Teaching Experience

Co-Instructor, Michigan State University

Introduction to International Relations (Dr. Cristina Bodea)	(scheduled) Spring 2027
Programming in R for Political Scientists (Graduate R Camp)	Summer 2026
Sports and the Social Sciences (Dr. Corwin Smidt)	Summers 2024-2026

Teaching Assistant, Michigan State University

Politics of International Organizations (Dr. Cristina Bodea)	Fall 2022, Spring 2026
Sports and the Social Sciences (Dr. Corwin Smidt)	Summer 2023
Introduction to Methods of Political Analysis (Dr. Andrew Kerner)	Summer 2022
Introduction to International Relations (Dr. Andrew Kerner)	AY 2021–22, Fall 2025

Mentoring, Michigan State University

Research Mentor, University Undergraduate Research and Arts Forum	Spring 2024

Conference Presentations

American Political Science Association	2023, 2025 (poster)
International Studies Association	2022, 2024-2026
Political Economy of International Organization	2027 (scheduled, poster)
Midwest Political Science Association	2023
PolMeth	2026 (poster)

Invited Talks & Workshops

Journeys in World Politics	2026
PolMeth Pre-Workshop Visions in Methodology	2026
ISA Pre-Conference: Shaping the Future of International Organization	2026
ISA Pay-It-Forward Mentoring Workshop	2025
International Graduate Student Symposium, National Chengchi University	2019

Fieldwork

Geneva, Switzerland — 2025
Conducted interviews, archival research, and on-site observation on United Nations human rights treaty monitoring mechanisms

Additional Training

Inter-university Consortium for Political and Social Research
Data Science and Text Analysis — Summer 2022

Korea Social Science Data Archive
Intermediate Statistics — Summer 2019

Academic Service

Michigan State University

Graduate Student Association Academic and Admissions Representative *2024 - 2025*

Diversity, Climate and Inclusion Committee Ph.D. Student Representative *2024 - 2025*

Joint IR-CP Workshop Graduate Student Organizer *2024 - 2025*

International Studies Association

Pay-It-Forward Alumna Panelist on Mentee Experience *2026*

Skills

Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (basic reading, writing; intermediate listening, Old HSK Level 5)

Programming: R, `Python`, LaTeX

Updated: October 2026